

🇮🇹 Italian Grammar Sheet (Beginner–Intermediate)

1) Future tense (Futuro semplice)

👉 Used for: “I will ...”

Structure:

Verb (infinitive) + future ending

Verb Future

parlare parlerò (I will speak)

vedere vedrò (I will see)

andare andrò (I will go)

Example:

Ti aiuterò = I will help you

Ti supporterò = I will support you

Sarà difficile = It will be difficult

2) Verb endings (-avo / -iamo / -ando)

A) -avo (Imperfetto = past continuous / habit)

Used for past habits or background actions.

parlavo = I was speaking / I used to speak

mangiavo = I was eating

👉 Example:

Quando ero bambino, giocavo sempre.

B) -iamo (Present tense plural: “we”)

Used for “we do something”

parliamo = we speak

andiamo = we go

👉 Example:

Andiamo a casa = We go home

C) -ando / -endo (Gerundio = “-ing”)

Used for actions happening now or simultaneously.

parlando = speaking

mangiando = eating

👉 Example:

Sto mangiando = I am eating

Camminando, ho visto lui = While walking, I saw him

3) mi hai + past participle (Passato prossimo)

Used for: something that happened to “me”

Structure:

mi + hai/ho/ha + verb (past participle)

mi hai aiutato = you helped me

mi hai visto = you saw me

👉 Example:

Mi hai chiamato = You called me

4) mi + verb (direct reflexive / passive feeling)

Used when something happens to “me”

mi piace = I like it (lit. it pleases me)

mi manca = I miss it

👉 Example:

Mi piace il caffè

5) verb + ti (you)

Used when action is done to “you”

ti vedo = I see you

ti chiamo = I call you

👉 Example:

Ti incontro = I meet you

Example with participle:

incontrati = met you (past participle form in structure)

6) verb + lo / la / li / le (object pronouns)

Used when replacing “it / him / her / them”

lo = him / it (masculine)

la = her / it (feminine)

Structure:

verb + pronoun (informal spoken often attached)

👉 Example:

dimmelo = tell me it

fallo = do it

prendilo = take it

7) ero vs stavo (past forms)

A) ero (essere = was)

Used for states / identity

ero stanco = I was tired

ero a casa = I was at home

B) stavo (stare = was doing)

Used for ongoing action

stavo studiando = I was studying

stavo mangiando = I was eating

8) verb + mi / ti (imperative form)

Used for commands:

aspettami = wait for me

chiamami = call me

aiutami = help me

Structure:

verb + mi/ti (attached pronoun)

👉 Example:

Dimmi = tell me

Seguimi = follow me

★ EXTRA IMPORTANT RULES

Reflexive verbs (very important in Italian)

mi sveglio = I wake up

ti svegli = you wake up

si sveglia = he/she wakes up

Word order tip:

In Italian:

👉 Pronouns often attach to verbs in commands and infinitive forms:

dirlo = to say it

farlo = to do it

🔥 Quick Memory Trick

mi / ti / lo = who receives action

-ando = happening now

-avo = past habit

-erò = future

-ato / -uto / -ito = past completed action

9) Want / Can / Must + Pronoun + Infinitive

👉 Used when you say:

“I want to see you / call you / meet you”

◆ Structure:

verb (voglio / posso / devo) + infinitive + pronoun attached

◆ Example: “I want to see you”

voglio = I want

vedere = to see

ti = you

👉 voglio vederti = I want to see you

✓ Rule:

ti goes to the end of the infinitive

◆ Other examples:

voglio chiamarti = I want to call you

posso aiutarti = I can help you

devo incontrarti = I must meet you

⚠ Important correction: “incontrati”

✗ incontrati alone is NOT correct for “meet you”

✓ Correct forms:

voglio incontrarti = I want to meet you

ti voglio incontrare = I want to meet you (more emphasis on “you”)

🔥 Extra Rule (very important in spoken Italian)

You can also move the pronoun before the verb:

ti voglio vedere = I want to see you

ti voglio incontrare = I want to meet you

👉 Both are correct:

attached form = more natural written/smooth

before verb = more spoken/emphatic

🧠 Memory trick:

voglio + verb + ti (at end) → voglio vederti

or ti + voglio + verb → ti voglio vedere

🇮🇹 Rule: Want / Can / Must + “you/me” in Italian

1) Basic structure

When you use verbs like:

voglio = I want

posso = I can

devo = I must

👉 You use:

✓ Structure A (most common)

verb + infinitive + pronoun attached

Example:

voglio vedere + ti → voglio vederti

posso aiutare + ti → posso aiutarti

devo incontrare + ti → devo incontrarti

2) What happens to “ti / mi / lo”?

👉 The pronoun moves to the end of the verb and attaches:

Before After

ti vedo voglio vederti

ti aiuto posso aiutarti

ti incontro devo incontrarti

3) Alternative structure (also correct)

✓ Structure B (more spoken/emphasis)

pronoun + verb + infinitive

ti voglio vedere

ti posso aiutare

ti devo incontrare

👉 Meaning is the same, just different style.

4) Important rule (the core idea)

🔥 The real rule:

When you have:

modal verb (voglio / posso / devo) + verb

👉 The second verb stays in infinitive

👉 The pronoun can:

attach to infinitive (vederti)

or go before everything (ti voglio vedere)

5) Common mistake you made

✗ incontrati alone = NOT correct

✓ correct forms:

voglio incontrarti

ti voglio incontrare

🧠 Easy memory rule:

INFINITIVE + TI → vederti

TI + VERB → ti voglio vedere

🇮🇹 3) mi hai detto / gli ho detto — what is the rule?

💠 1) Basic structure (Passato Prossimo)

👉 Used for: something that already happened

Structure:

subject pronoun (optional) + auxiliary verb (ho / hai / ha / abbiamo...) + past participle

Example:

ho detto = I said

hai detto = you said

ha detto = he/she said

◆ 2) Adding pronouns (mi / ti / gli / le)

Now we add to whom the action happened.

✓ Structure:

pronoun + auxiliary + past participle

◆ Example 1: "You told me"

mi = to me

hai detto = you said

👉 mi hai detto = you told me

✓ Literal:

"to me you have said"

◆ Example 2: "I told him"

gli = to him

ho detto = I said

👉 gli ho detto = I told him

✓ Literal:

"to him I have said"

◆ 3) Full pronoun list (important)

Pronoun	Meaning
---------	---------

mi	to me
----	-------

ti	to you
----	--------

gli	to him
-----	--------

le	to her
----	--------

ci	to us
----	-------

vi	to you (plural)
----	-----------------

◆ 4) More examples

ti ho visto = I saw you

mi hai chiamato = you called me

gli ho parlato = I spoke to him

le ho detto = I told her

ci hanno aiutato = they helped us

🔥 5) Important rule (VERY IMPORTANT)

👉 In Italian:

✓ pronoun ALWAYS comes BEFORE the verb

So:

mi hai detto ❌ NOT after
gli ho detto ❌ NOT after

Correct:

mi hai detto
gli ho detto

🧠 Memory trick:

👉 English: "you told me"

👉 Italian: "me you have said" (mi hai detto)

★ SUPER SIMPLE RULE SUMMARY:

mi / ti / gli = BEFORE ho / hai / ha

used in past actions

structure = pronoun + auxiliary + past participle

🇮🇹 "vengo da te / arrivo da te" — rule

◆ 1) Basic idea

👉 da + person = "to someone's place / toward someone"

So:

da te = to you / at your place

da me = to me / at my place

da lui / da lei = to him / to her

◆ 2) vengo da te

✓ Structure:

venire (to come) + da + person

👉 vengo da te = I come to you

✓ Meaning:

I move toward you

I come to your place

Example:

Vengo da te stasera = I'm coming to you tonight

♦ 3) arrivo da te

✓ Structure:

arrivare (to arrive) + da + person/place

👉 arrivo da te = I arrive at your place / I come to you

✓ Meaning:

focuses on reaching the destination

Example:

Arrivo da te alle 8 = I arrive at your place at 8

🔥 Difference (important)

Expression	Focus
vengo da te	movement / coming toward you
arrivo da te	arrival / reaching you

👉 In real life, they often mean almost the same.

♦ 4) More examples

vengo da lui = I come to him

vengo da lei = I come to her

arrivo da voi = I arrive at your place (plural you)

arrivo da Marco = I arrive at Marco's place

🧠 Easy memory trick

venire = coming toward you

arrivare = reaching the place

★ Super important structure rule

👉 In Italian:

verb + da + person = direction toward someone

Examples:

vengo da te

vado da te

passo da te

arrivo da te